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LT03

Unit 3 Elements of Crime and Mystery

Mark scheme

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Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.

2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.

3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.

4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.

5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.

6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.

7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

Using the mark bands

8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

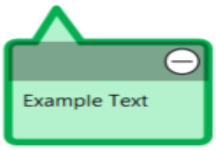
MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.

10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.

11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Red Line		 Toolbar Tooltip: Red Line		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Unfocused		Toolbar Tooltip: Unfocused		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Factual Inaccuracy		Toolbar Tooltip: Factual Inaccuracy		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 18 years old so we are judging their skills at the end of Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 **Perceptive/Assured** **21–25 marks** '**Perception**' is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. '**Assuredness**' is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	• Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by **perceptive** and **assured** work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently **assured** and will demonstrate sensitivity and **perception** across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some **perception** but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	• Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. • Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 **Coherent/Thorough** **16–20 marks** '**Coherence**' is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. '**Thoroughness**' is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	• Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by **coherent** and **thorough** work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully **coherent** and **thorough** argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in **coherence** and accuracy.
	AO2	• Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. • Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 **Straightforward/ Relevant** **11–15 marks** '**Straightforward**' work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. '**Relevant**' work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by **straightforward** and **relevant** work where the student's response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent **straightforward** understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed **relevantly**. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of **relevant** understanding with evidence of **straightforward** thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 **Simple/Generalised** **6–10 marks** '**Simple**' work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. '**Generalised**' work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by **simple** and **generalised** work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic **generalised** understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a **simple** way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a **simple** and **generalised** understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 **Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate** **1–5 marks** '**Largely irrelevant**' work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. '**Largely misunderstood**' and '**largely inaccurate**' work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is **largely irrelevant** and **largely misunderstood** and **largely inaccurate**, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and **irrelevant**.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0 1 **William Shakespeare: *Macbeth***

'Victims of crime are rarely entirely innocent.'

Discuss this view with reference to Shakespeare's presentation of victims in Macbeth.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *Macbeth* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Duncan who is presented as a loyal and decent king, seen most clearly in his welcome and rewarding of Macbeth and Banquo
- Banquo who is innocent of any explicit crimes but who is equally intrigued by what the witches have to offer him, and who appears envious of Macbeth's fortune
- Lady Macduff and her son who are presented as entirely innocent
- Lady Macbeth who is a victim of her own crime but who is not remotely innocent
- Malcolm who is a proxy victim through the murder of his father and his need to flee for his life
- Duncan's guards who are entirely innocent of his murder.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the implied stage direction 'let me infold thee' which reflects Duncan's decency and innocence
- Shakespeare's presentation of Duncan as divine, as God's representative on earth, through the description of his 'silver skin lac'd with . . . golden blood'
- Banquo's soliloquy which reveals his own ambition and envy
- the ending of the play focusing on Malcolm's (who is a victim of his father's murder) speech which highlights his goodness and innocence 'by the grace of Grace'
- Lady Macbeth's infamous instruction to Macbeth to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under it' which implies innocence is an act
- Lady Macduff's repetition of 'I have done no harm'.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0 2 **Samuel Taylor Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner***

How far do you agree that in *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*, Coleridge shows that criminal acts ultimately cause greater mental than physical suffering?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, **and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.**

Focus might be on:

- the extreme drought and thirst that the Mariner and the crew suffer as a result of the killing of the albatross
- the Mariner's drinking of his own blood in order to quench his thirst
- the Mariner's suffering as a result of his guilt at the death of his crew
- the Mariner's suffering as a result of his eternal quest for atonement for the killing of the albatross
- the crew's cursing of the Mariner before they died
- some students might consider 'ultimately' and 'greater'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the repetition of 'water' and 'black lips' which emphasises the extremity of the crew's thirst
- the physical description of the Mariner which focuses on his age and degree of malnourishment
- the symbolic hanging of the albatross around the Mariner's neck which represents his psychological suffering
- the use of extreme settings to depict both the physical and emotional sufferings of the Mariner
- the narrative perspective of the wedding guest who is fearful of the haggard appearance of the mariner caused by his physical and psychological sufferings.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0 3 **Robert Browning: *Selected Poems***

Explore the view that Browning always presents his criminals as a mixture of good and evil.

In your answer, you should make reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.
Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied Browning's *Selected Poems* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the Piper who initially is fair and good and is justified in his anger at his treatment, but who punishes the children of Hamelin, not the Mayor and the corporation
- the Patriot who believes he has only done good deeds but who it is implied has done wrong
- Gauthier who is presented as evil by the narrator because of his false accusations, but who it is revealed at the end, may have been actually telling the truth
- the psychological torment of the narrator in 'Times Revenges'
- the Mayor in 'The Piper', the narrator in 'The Laboratory' and the Duke in 'My Last Duchess' who are entirely evil.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the duality of the Piper's physical presentation which symbolises the two sides of his character
- the language used to present the children as innocent victims suggesting the Piper's actions are evil
- the first person narrative in 'The Patriot' which only allows for one perspective of the Patriot's 'misdeeds'
- the ending of 'Count Gismond' which implies that the real criminal may be the narrator who has lied and orchestrated the death of Gauthier
- the symbolic imagery of heaven and hell in 'Times Revenges'
- the setting of 'The Laboratory' which presents the narrator as sinister and associated with witchcraft.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0 4 **Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist***

'Poverty is presented as the main cause of crime in *Oliver Twist*.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the novel?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *Oliver Twist* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Fagin's gang whose pickpocketing keeps them fed and within a family of sorts
- the presentation of crime as a way out of poverty seen through characters such as Dodger and Charlie Bates
- the widely held belief that poverty equaled criminality, seen in Oliver's interactions at the workhouse and the undertakers
- Nancy and Oliver who are both lured into crime through their need for someone to 'care' for them
- crime as the only way of making independent provision for eg Nancy, Dodger and Oliver
- Nancy's speech to Rose, explaining why she must return to a life of vice
- that actually it is greed which is the cause of numerous crimes throughout the narrative such as Monks' desire to disinherit Oliver, Mrs Mann and Mr Bumble's starvation of those in their care, and Fagin and Sikes' abuse of the pick-pockets.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Dickens starting the novel with the setting of the workhouse, presenting poverty as the impetus for the following events and crimes
- the interactions between Nancy and Sikes which present her as fearful but also as beholding to him
- the details of Oliver's lonely, desperate journey to London contrasted with the convivial warmth of Fagin's den with its sizzling sausages
- the harsh language used about the poor by those in authority
- the language of excess used to describe the quantity of silk handkerchiefs and the jewels hoarded by Fagin implying they reflect greed as a cause rather than poverty
- the comical tone of the Dodger's trial which seems to imply his professional pride in his crimes rather than presenting them as a way of combatting poverty.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 5 **Edgar Allen Poe: *Collected Stories***

To what extent do you agree that all the criminals in Poe's short stories are presented as being the victims of their own disturbed minds?

In your answer, you should make reference to 'The Tell-Tale Heart' and at least one other story.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied Poe's *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the narrator and criminal in 'The Tell-Tale Heart' who repeatedly references his nerves and his disease
- the narrator's behaviour in front of the police-men when he 'foamed' and 'raved' and then confessed to the crime
- the narrator's repeated assurances that his crime is not a result of a disturbed mind
- Madeline and Roderick who both could be seen to commit crimes in 'The Fall of the House of Usher' and who are descendants of a family with a 'peculiar sensibility of temperament' implying they are victims of a hereditary disease
- the acknowledgement of the narrator and criminal in 'The Black Cat' of his own change in character which he says is a result of 'the Fiend Intemperance'
- the narrator's evil glee and triumph when he believes he has tricked the authorities.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the direct address in 'The Tell-Tale Heart', which is an attempt to convince the reader that the narrator's violence is not an act of madness
- the first person narrative at the end of the story which is full of exclamatives and fragmented, disturbed thoughts
- structural features such as the reference to a letter from Roderick at the start where he explicitly describes his 'nervous agitation' and desire for the narrator to offer some 'alleviation' to his 'malady'
- structural features such as the narrator presenting himself as being kind and docile before he fell victim to the 'Fiend Intemperance'
- the language choices that the narrators of 'The Black Cat' and 'The Tell Tale Heart' use to describe their own behaviour.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 6 **Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories***

Explore the view that Stevenson presents his victims as suffering only because they were in the wrong place at the wrong time.

In your answer make reference to at least two stories.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied Stevenson's *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the child who is trampled by Hyde and who is left 'screaming on the ground'
- Danvers Carew who is murdered in a random and sadistic attack
- Jane Galbraith who 'was alive and hearty' just a day before her body is delivered to Fettes and who has 'marks on her body' that demonstrate her physical sufferings
- Gray who is murdered by MacFarlane as a direct result of his involvement in the criminal underworld and his goading
- the dealer in 'Markheim' who is murdered because he does business with those who 'cannot look (him) in the eye but whose suffering is seen as pitiful
- Thevenin who is murdered by a member of the 'thievish crew' with whom he has chosen to associate
- candidates might consider 'the wrong place at the wrong time' as a choice to be in a place of crime or danger, rather than as accidental.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of Jekyll's letter for Utterson which explains the random nature of Carew's murder
- the descriptive detail used to describe Hyde's indiscriminate violence and force
- the use of a first person narrative in 'The Body Snatcher' which reveals Fettes' horror at his discovery that the previously healthy Jane has been murdered
- the setting of 19th century Edinburgh and the inclusion of Dr K which reminds the reader of the Burke and Hare murders where victims were randomly selected for the murderer's convenience
- the significance of the strategic murder of Gray being emphasised by the climactic ending of 'The Body Snatcher'
- the narrative of 'Markheim' opening on the dealer's dialogue and his smug pleasure in profiting from those who are dishonest
- the scientific detail used to convey Thevenin's suffering.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 7 **Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd***

'Though guilty of crimes themselves, ultimately Flora and Mrs Ackroyd are presented more as victims than villains.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- some students may sensibly look at the two characters independently
- Flora's crime of theft and Mrs Ackroyd's crimes of borrowing from illegal lenders, snooping and stealing from her brother-in-law
- the description of Flora as 'more dancing than walking' and as full of joy not long after Ackroyd's death
- Poirot's statement that 'life is not easy for that mother and daughter' which acknowledges the difficulties for upper class women who were at the mercy of their husbands and inheritances
- Flora, who is the instigator for justice and who fights to clear Ralph's name despite Poirot's warning that the investigation will have an impact on her life
- Poirot's recognition that Flora needed to escape her life at Fernly Park and that her engagement to Ralph was entirely engineered by Roger and Mrs Ackroyd
- Flora's fainting in response to her discovery that Roger Ackroyd has been murdered.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the narrative perspective which presents Mrs Ackroyd in a villainous manner as 'all chains and teeth and bones'
- the introduction to Flora which states that 'quite a lot of people do not like Flora Ackroyd'
- Christie's repetition of the line' strain of weakness' to describe the villains in The Murder of Roger Ackroyd
- Mrs Ackroyd's xenophobic and classist language choices
- the euphemistic language in Mrs Ackroyd's confession which reveals her hypocritical middle class standards
- the contrast between Flora's shame and self-disgust during her confession with Mrs Ackroyd's attempts to present herself as entirely respectable.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 8 **Qiu Xiaolong: *Death of a Red Heroine***

'Guan Hongying is ultimately presented as a victim of political power and control.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *Death of a Red Heroine* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the early desire of the authorities to 'hush up' Guan's murder due to her status as a National Model Worker
- Guan's weeping overheard by her neighbour which implies her deep unhappiness as a result of the controlling influence the party had on her life
- Guan having to reject Lei Feng because he was a politically incorrect match for her, and Chen's belief that had she chosen to remain with him she would still be alive
- that Guan's murder was prompted by her becoming a threat to Wu's political ambitions
- Chen's reflection that Guan 'lived in the Party's interests. It appeared only logical that she should die in the Party's interests'
- the argument that Guan is actually a victim of her own repressed passions, a view that Chen himself offers
- the inclusion of Wu's obscene, pornographic photographs which suggest Guan is a victim of male power and desire.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the setting of Guan's tiny room with sparse belongings suggesting her status as a victim because she had to live the life of a selfless model worker, devoted to party ideas
- the repeated imagery of Guan's 'magical mask'
- the comparison between Guan and Madam A Qin, a well-known character from Shajiabang, a woman who suffered loneliness because any romantic passion was considered to detract from her political commitment
- the inclusion of the poem from Wang Changlin which acts as a metaphor for Guan's regrets
- the inclusion of Dr Xia's medical report which details the physical trauma that Guan suffered including the fact that the evidence suggests she could have been raped
- the intertextual reference to Miaoyu, a nun, who is a victim of her long sexual repression and the comparison made to Guan's own sacrifices.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 9 **Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?***

How far do you agree that in the world of *When Will There be Good News*, Atkinson presents violence as breeding violence?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the assessment objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that, because students have read and studied *When Will There Be Good News?* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Joanna who is seemingly unable to escape the violent behaviour of others
- Reggie who is the victim of violence as a result of her brother's criminal dealings with Ginger and Blondie
- the deaths of Alison Needler's mother, sister and neighbour at the hands of her husband's violent rage
- Andrew Decker's suicide, presumably as a result of his guilt at his violence against Gabriella Mason and her family
- Joanna's killing of the kidnappers who have threatened violence to her and her child
- Louise's repeated desire to inflict violence on those who have done harm
- Jackson who has left the army, but who is unable to 'leave behind carnage and horror'.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Reggie's statement that 'just because something bad happened to her once, doesn't mean it won't happen again. Believe me, bad things happen to me all the time' which is given authorial approval through her being proven right
- the title which implies a cycle of bad news
- the opening and the climax of the novel which both focus on violence against Joanna
- the use of the focalised narrative to offer Louise's musings that men commit violence against women because of violence or neglect in their own childhood
- the violent language used by the kidnappers to threaten Joanna and her son
- the use of the focalised narrative to give access to Reggie's beliefs that she is 'the kiss of death' and brings violence and death to those she loves.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.